



30 Biometrics



36 The Future Of Search



46 Lords Of The Code

Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

CRIME And The CITY

What safeguards are in place to ensure your online security? According to experts, not many

Aditya Kuber

Cyber crime is defined as “an unlawful act where information in a computer is used either as a tool, as a target or both”. To tackle the growing menace of online crime, the IT Act of 2000 was framed. It was greeted with much fanfare. Upon closer inspection, though, many chinks in its armour have shown up. For example, do you know that you could face impris-

onment just for sitting in front of a computer terminal—even if it’s off? Far-fetched as that may sound, the current laws can actually be interpreted in a manner so as to make such silly-sounding scenarios a reality. The fact remains that in India, your online safety is not guaranteed, especially if you are the victim.

There are some steps that have been taken of late, though, that may just make it a little safer to stay online. The Mumbai Police recently set up a Cyber Crime lab in association with NASSCOM, and there is also the Bangalore Cyber Crime Police Station, which is actively tackling the growing problem of



Illustration: Shivam Shrivastava, Pradipta Ingole